

Burak Kalafat

Senior Backend Engineer | .NET & Technical Leadership

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Istanbul, Turkey | Europe/Istanbul

Professional Summary

Senior backend engineer and .NET specialist with nearly 14 years of experience in financial services, banking systems, and legacy modernization. Leads architecture, code reviews, and mentoring across banking engagements, from COBOL/mainframe transformation to .NET backend design. Combines hands-on C# development, database integration, and asynchronous programming with international remote team experience and practical AI-assisted engineering.

Technical Skills

Backend Engineering: C#, .NET, .NET Core, ASP.NET MVC, REST APIs, EF Core, Asynchronous programming, WCF

Architecture and Design: Clean Architecture, Legacy modernization, Service-oriented architecture, Repository, Unit of Work, Facade, Strategy

Databases: SQL Server (MSSQL), Oracle, PL/SQL

Languages and Frameworks: Java, Spring, TypeScript, JavaScript, WPF, WinForms, Knockout.js

DevOps: Azure DevOps, GitHub Actions, CI/CD

AI-Assisted Development: GitHub Copilot Enterprise, Prompt engineering, Spec-Driven Development (SDD)

Quality and Leadership: Unit testing, Playwright E2E testing, Code reviews, Mentoring, Architecture guidance, Coding standards

Training: Microservices, Distributed systems, .NET with AWS, Containerization, React

Professional Experience

Senior Software Engineer (Backend, .NET) | Innovance

May 2024 - Present | Istanbul, Turkey (Remote)

- Akbank: Led COBOL/mainframe modernization into C# and Java backend services for banking systems.
- Guided architecture, coding standards, and mentoring using Clean Architecture and Repository, Unit of Work, Facade, and Strategy patterns.
- Applied specification-driven workflows and AI-assisted development to align implementation with requirements.
- Türkiye Finans: Developed internet and mobile banking backends using ASP.NET MVC, WCF, and SQL Server, with unit tests.

Technologies: C#, .NET, Java, ASP.NET MVC, WCF, SQL Server, GitHub Copilot Enterprise, Azure DevOps, GitHub Actions

Senior Software Engineer (Backend, .NET) | insightsoftware

September 2022 - April 2024 | North Carolina, USA (Remote)

- Contributed to backend architecture, design, and implementation of C# and .NET Core features in an international remote team.

Technologies: C#, .NET Core, Backend architecture

Senior Software Engineer (Backend, .NET) | OBSS

September 2017 - September 2022 | Istanbul, Turkey

- Halkbank: Led mobile banking backend migration from .NET Framework to .NET Core and Clean Architecture, applying asynchronous programming and thread optimization.
- Built REST APIs with EF Core and SQL Server, using Repository and Unit of Work patterns and Azure DevOps CI/CD pipelines.
- Türkiye Finans: Owned code reviews, mentored developers, and established coding standards; developed corporate customer applications with WinForms and WCF.
- Akbank: Led full-stack development for a payment system campaign using TypeScript, Knockout.js, C#, Java/Spring, and Oracle 12c.

Technologies: .NET Core, REST APIs, EF Core, SQL Server, Azure DevOps, TypeScript, Knockout.js, Java, Spring, Oracle 12c, WinForms, WCF

Java Developer | TÜBİTAK

January 2017 - September 2017 | Kocaeli, Turkey

- Developed Java software using APDU commands to write EAC/SAC security data to passport smartcard chips for government identification systems.

Technologies: Java, APDU, Smartcards, EAC/SAC

.NET Developer | VakıfBank

August 2013 - January 2017 | Istanbul, Turkey

- Modernized CRM and collections applications toward service-oriented architecture using WPF/MVVM, WCF, Oracle 11g, and PL/SQL.

Technologies: .NET, WPF, MVVM, WCF, Oracle 11g, PL/SQL

Part-Time .NET Developer | VeriPark

December 2012 - June 2013 | Izmir, Turkey

- Built ASP.NET widgets for Turkcell's SharePoint environment while completing the Computer Engineering degree.

Technologies: ASP.NET, SharePoint

Education

BSc in Computer Engineering

Ege University, Izmir, Turkey | September 2008 - June 2013

Certifications and Training

Microsoft Certified: Azure AI Engineer Associate

Microsoft | Certification | March 6, 2026 | Expires March 6, 2027 | Certification overview (AI-102)

Introduction to GitHub Copilot

Microsoft Learn | Training | 2024 | Course overview

Build Microservices with .NET and Amazon Web Services

Udemy | Training | February 2024

IELTS - Band 7

British Council | Language test | 2023

React Nanodegree Program

Udacity | Training | February 2020

Languages

Turkish: Native; English: Professional proficiency; IELTS Band 7 (2023)

Interests

Chess; LLM and RAG applications; AI-powered customer service; Travel and cultural exchange